October 2026

Guillem Foucault i Llopart

guillem.foucault@tse-fr.eu gfill.github.io +34 625 544 140

Contact details
Toulouse School of Economics
1, Esplanade de l'Université,
31000 Toulouse FRANCE

Personal information
Pronouns: he/him
Citizenship: French & Spanish

Placement Officers
Prof. Mathias Reynaert
mathias.reynaert@tse-fr.eu
Dr. Paul Diegert
paul.diegert@tse-fr.eu

Placement Administrator
Louise Strachan
louise.strachan@tse-fr.eu

Education

Ph.D. in Economics [*expected*], Toulouse School of Economics 2022-2027
Visiting Scholar, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia (US) Spring 2025
MRes. in Economics, Toulouse School of Economics 2021-2022
M.Sc. in Economic Theory and Econometrics, Toulouse School of Economics 2020-2021
M.Sc. in Economics, Toulouse School of Economics 2019-2020
B.Sc. in Economics, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Barcelona (Spain) 2013-2017
Visiting Student, Aalto-yliopisto, Helsinki (Finland) 2015

References

Prof. Matteo Bobba
Toulouse School of Economics
matteo.bobba@tse-fr.eu

Prof. Olivier De Groote
Toulouse School of Economics
olivier.de-groote@tse-fr.eu

Dr. Ana Gazmuri
Toulouse School of Economics
ana.gazmuri@udp.cl

Dr. François Poinas
Toulouse School of Economics
francois.poinas@tse-fr.eu

Research interests

Primary field: Labor Economics.
Secondary fields: Education Economics, Applied Microeconomics.

Teaching experience

Teaching Assistant Coordinator

Toulouse School of Economics
Program Evaluation, graduate 2024-2025

Teaching Assistant

Toulouse School of Economics
Program Evaluation, graduate 2022-2025
Applied Econometrics, graduate 2023-2024

Université Toulouse 1 Capitole
Microeconomics I 2022-2023
Macroeconomics II 2021-2023

Relevant positions

Research Stay at the Ministry of Education, Santiago (Chile) Fall 2024
On-site access to administrative microdata for doctoral research.
Consultant at The World Bank 2021-2023
Research Assistant to Pepita Miquel-Florensa, Toulouse School of Economics 2020
Data Analyst at FocusEconomics, Barcelona (Spain) 2017-2019

Fellowships and Awards

Mobility grant, Toulouse School of Economics 2025
Doctoral contract, Université Toulouse 1 Capitole 2022-2025
MRes Funded Position, Toulouse School of Economics 2021-2022
M2 ETE Funded Position, Toulouse School of Economics 2020-2021

Job Market Paper

Funding Instruments and Effort Choices in Higher Education, with Juan Pal

This paper examines the effects of tuition-free higher education (TF) policies on student enrollment and academic performance, focusing on the 2016 Chilean reform that eliminated higher education tuition fees for students from the lowest five income deciles. Using a difference-in-differences approach, we find that TF increased enrollment among eligible students by around 4 percentage points—concentrated among lower-ability students—and both reduced dropout rates and increased graduation rates among students enrolled before the reform. For post-reform cohorts, these effects diminish: graduation and on-time graduation gains persist but are smaller, and the dropout reduction vanishes. To disentangle the role of student effort from composition effects, we develop a dynamic structural model in which students choose effort levels in response to financial incentives. The model reproduces the enrollment response estimated by difference-in-differences and its concentration among lower-ability students. Counterfactual simulations show that reintroducing annual progress requirements reduces the cost per additional graduate from $108,000 to $70,000, but widens socioeconomic gaps in graduation. Minimum entry scores would raise the cost per additional graduate nearly threefold and leave the socioeconomic gap almost unchanged. Phasing out the benefit for middle-income students and providing a stipend to the poorest raises graduation as much as TF does, at lower cost and with a smaller socioeconomic gap.

Working paper

Differences in returns to vocational and general education: evidence from a differentiated schooling system, with François Poinas

The literature on returns to education has focused on years of schooling and fields of study, and less on whether post-secondary education is vocational or academic. We study how this choice affects occupations and wages in Germany. We estimate a dynamic semi-structural model of completed post-secondary education and first occupation choice, using the German Socio-Economic Panel. Occupations are described by their cognitive, interpersonal and manual task content, and selection runs through latent cognitive and non-cognitive abilities. Cognitive ability strongly predicts post-secondary attainment, especially university, while non-cognitive ability plays no role once cognitive ability is accounted for. Conditional on abilities and occupational tasks, an apprenticeship raises first-job hourly wages by 11% relative to basic education, and a university degree by 45%. Vocational degrees move workers towards manual and cognitive occupations and away from interpersonal ones. This occupational sorting explains only a modest part of the wage returns to education (8 to 20%), and almost none of the gap between university and apprenticeship graduates, which arises within occupations.

Work in progress

Co-Residence, Housing and Labor Market Decisions

General Equilibrium Effects of Large-Scale Education Expansions, with Matteo Bobba, Olivier De Groote, Ana Gazmuri and Juan Pal

While small-scale educational interventions provide valuable insights into effective investments, large-scale education programs may generate substantial general equilibrium (GE) effects that alter their ultimate impact on welfare and inequality. This paper analyzes the consequences of a large-scale college enrollment expansion in Chile, explicitly accounting for GE effects in both education and labor markets, to understand how firms adjust their demand for skill-biased labor in response to increased college graduate supply. The model enables us to decompose observed wage changes into individual returns to education and GE effects, revealing how firm responses shape education decisions and ultimately affect the distribution of earnings. By incorporating both household education choices and firm production decisions, this framework provides a comprehensive assessment of how large-scale education expansions affect welfare and distributional outcomes.

Policy work

Background Note on Bringing Climate Change into Vulnerability Analysis, with Sandra Baquie. The World Bank, 2023.

Professional activities

Service: European Network for Training in Economic Research (ENTER) network coordinator. 2023-2026

Seminars and conferences

41st meeting of the European Economic Association, 38th European Association of Labour Economists Conference, Maastricht University (expected), University College London (expected). 2026

Penn Empirical Micro Lunch, ENTER Jamboree, TSE Economics of Education Workshop, 40th meeting of the European Economic Association, Mannheim University, European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society, Dynamic Structural Econometrics Conference of the Econometric Society, 50th Symposium of the Spanish Economic Association. 2025

TSE Economics of Education Workshop. 2024

Other information

Software R, Stata, Python, SQL.
Languages English (fluent), Catalan (native), French (native), Spanish (native), German (beginner).